HOOK

Claude Code just became programmable

Not a new model. A new layer of control over the one you already use.

- Four separate channels covered mods in under 36 hours
- That's an adoption spike, not one creator's hype

WHAT IT IS

Mods let you intercept the agent's behavior

You write JS/TS functions that hook into how Claude Code runs.

- Intercept tool calls before or after they execute
- Add custom terminal panels inside the CLI
- Reshape behavior using plain-English instructions

WHY IT MATTERS

A fixed tool just became a dev environment

Most people use Claude Code as-is. Mods change that assumption.

- You're no longer limited to default tool behavior
- The agent becomes an extensible system, not a fixed product
- This is the same shift IDEs went through with plugins

MECHANISM

Where mods actually sit in the loop

Think of it as middleware between you and the agent's actions.

- Tool call triggers your function first
- Your function can modify, block, or log the call
- Agent behavior updates based on your custom logic

LESSON 1

Start by observing, not changing

Before modifying behavior, log what the agent is actually doing.

- Intercept and log tool calls first
- You'll see patterns you didn't expect
- This prevents fixing a problem that doesn't exist

LESSON 2

Treat mods like code, not prompts

Plain-English instructions still run inside real functions.

- Version control your mods like any other script
- Test them in isolation before combining several
- A broken mod changes agent behavior silently

LESSON 3

Custom panels are for visibility, not vanity

The terminal panel feature is useful when it reduces guesswork.

- Use panels to surface state the agent is tracking
- Good panels answer: what is it about to do next
- Skip panels that just look impressive in a demo

TAKEAWAY

Mods are a control layer, not a gimmick

The real value is predictability, not customization for its own sake.

- Map what you'd want to intercept before writing a mod
- Start with logging, then add constraints, then behavior
- Treat it as infrastructure your team can maintain

CTA

Already experimenting with Claude Code mods?

I'm curious what people are intercepting first.

- Tell me what you're building or testing
- Happy to compare approaches if you're exploring this

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